10th Class English • Review 2 (Units 6–10) • Punjab Board 2026

Review 2 — Units 6 to 10

Fully solved review: comprehension across the five units, grammar (narration, gerund/infinitive/participle, past perfect, punctuation), oral tasks and four writing tasks

A. Reading and Critical Thinking

1. How do both education and family contribute to preventing drug abuse among young people?

Education works on the mind. A student who has been taught the facts in simple words — what heroin, hashish, opium and ice do to the brain, the heart, the lungs and the liver — cannot be tempted by the sentence "it is only a harmless experiment". Schools add to this knowledge the skills that keep a young person away from drugs: sports, art, debating and hobby clubs give his energy a healthy outlet, and a counsellor gives him somebody to talk to when he is in trouble. Education also raises his ambitions, and a student who is working towards a career has too much to lose.

Family works on the heart. Parents give the emotional security which an addict is usually looking for: a child who is heard at home does not need to be heard by bad company. The family sets the example — a home without smoking or drinking is a strong protection — watches for the early signs (falling marks, new friends, missing money, moodiness), keeps medicines and money safely, and reacts with love instead of insult if a problem appears. So education supplies knowledge and the family supplies belonging; a young person needs both, because drugs attack the mind and the heart together.

2. What emotions and ideas does the speaker associate with the poem "Time", and how are these conveyed through imagery?

Shelley associates **sorrow, awe and helplessness** with time, and every one of these feelings arrives through an image rather than a statement. **Sorrow** comes in the picture of water that is "brackish with the salt of human tears" — grief has become the taste of life itself. **Awe** comes in the "unfathomable sea" and the "shoreless flood", which are too large for the eye or the mind to measure. **Cruelty and fear** come in the animal images — time is "sick of prey, yet howling on for more" and "vomitest thy wrecks on its inhospitable shore". **Deception** comes in the line "treacherous in calm, and terrible in storm", and **total helplessness** in the last rhetorical question, "Who shall put forth on thee, / Unfathomable Sea?" So the ideas are abstract but the imagery is physical: the reader sees water, hears howling and feels the cold of the sea, and through the senses the ideas become emotions.

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3. What are the main environmental challenges caused by climate change and pollution, and how are people around the world responding to them?

Challenges. Climate change is raising temperatures, melting glaciers and lifting sea levels, and it is making extreme weather — hurricanes, floods, heatwaves, wildfires, droughts — more frequent and more intense. Pollution adds its own damage: smoke from vehicles and factories poisons the air and causes asthma, skin infections and heart disease; plastic and chemicals dumped in rivers poison water; and deforestation destroys soil, reduces greenery and drives out biodiversity. Together they hit food production, health and homes, and they hit the poorest countries hardest although those countries pollute the least.

Responses. At the world level, almost every country signed the Paris Agreement in 2015 and promised to keep warming well below 2°C, with efforts for 1.5°C, by cutting emissions and investing in renewable energy. Businesses are shifting to sustainable practices and clean technology, and campaigns have pushed leaders to act. At the national and local level, governments are enforcing environmental laws and promoting solar and wind power, cities are improving public transport, communities are running “Green Day” and “Clean Street Campaigns”, and schools and youth groups are planting trees and cleaning parks and riversides — as the examples of Islamabad's plantation drives and school rooftop gardens show. Young people, in particular, have turned climate action into a global conversation rather than a fringe concern.

4. What is the significance of the “two roads” in “The Road Not Taken”, and how does the speaker feel about the choice he made?

The two roads are a **symbol of the choices of life**. They are described as almost equal — “really about the same”, “equally lay in leaves” — which shows that most of life's decisions are not clearly good or bad at the moment we make them. What matters is that we must choose one, and that the choice, once made, cannot be repeated, because “way leads on to way”. The speaker's feelings are mixed: he begins with **regret** that he cannot travel both, feels **quiet satisfaction** in the road he takes, admits **uncertainty** about ever returning, and at the end looks back **with a sigh** — a mixture of pride, nostalgia and a faint “what if”. The poem also quietly warns us that we like to flatter ourselves afterwards: he says he took the “less traveled” road, though the poem has already told us that both roads were the same.

5. Why did the King decide to visit the hermit, and what steps did he take to ensure the hermit would see him?

The King decided to visit the hermit because the learned men of his kingdom had given him contradictory answers to his three questions and he was not satisfied with any of them. The hermit was famous for his wisdom, and because he was a holy man who wanted nothing from the world, his advice could not be bought — so the King trusted him more than the scholars.

To make sure the hermit would see him, the King **did not send a message or a servant first**; he put on simple clothes like a common man, left his horse, his guards and his attendants on the road, and walked the rest of the way alone to the

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hut. He also **waited patiently** while the hermit went on digging and gave no answer, and instead of insisting on his royal rights he took the spade and dug the beds himself. In this way he came as a humble visitor and not as a king, which is why the hermit received him and later gave him the answers.

B. Vocabulary and Grammar

1. Rewrite the excerpt from “Time” with appropriate punctuation to clarify its meaning: “unfathomable sea whose waves are years ocean of time whose waters of deep woe are brackish with the salt of human tears”

“Unfathomable Sea! whose waves are years, / Ocean of Time, whose waters of deep woe / Are brackish with the salt of human tears!”

Points to notice: capital letters for “Unfathomable Sea” and “Ocean of Time” because they are personified; an exclamation mark after “Sea” for the cry of the apostrophe; a comma after “years” and after “woe” to mark the end of each line; and a final exclamation mark because the whole sentence is an exclamation of grief and awe.

2. Rewrite the sentence, changing the verb tense to the past perfect: “Around the world, individuals, communities, and governments are pushing back against environmental destruction.”

Around the world, individuals, communities and governments had pushed back against environmental destruction.

Reason: the past perfect is formed with had + the third form (past participle) of the verb, and it is used for an action completed before another past action or before a point in the past. The present continuous “are pushing back” therefore becomes “had pushed back”.

3. Identify the gerund, infinitive and participle in the sentence and explain their function: “Monitoring land degradation and designing eco-friendly practices are essential for promoting sustainability in tourism.”

Gerunds: “**Monitoring** land degradation” and “**designing** eco-friendly practices” — both are gerunds (verb + ing used as a noun) and together they form the **compound subject** of the verb “are essential”. “**promoting** sustainability” is also a gerund; it is the **object of the preposition “for”**.

Infinitive: there is no infinitive in this sentence. An infinitive is to + base verb, and it would appear if the sentence were written as “these practices are essential **to promote** sustainability in tourism” — where “to promote” works as an adverb telling why the practices are essential.

Participle: there is no participle (verb + ing used as an adjective, or the third form used as an adjective) in this sentence either. A participle would appear in a phrase such as “**degraded** land” (past participle) or “**monitoring** satellites” (present participle) — where the verb form describes a noun instead of doing the work of a verb or a noun.

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The same -ing form can be a gerund, a participle or part of a verb. Ask what job it is doing: noun → gerund; adjective → participle; verb → continuous tense.

4. Change into indirect speech: The King said to the hermit, “I have come to you, wise hermit, to ask you to answer three questions.”

The King told the hermit that he had come to him, wise hermit, to ask him to answer three questions.

Changes made: “said to” → “told”; “I” → “he”; “you” → “him”; “have come” → “had come” (present perfect → past perfect); and the inverted commas are replaced by the connector “that”.

C. Oral Communication Skills

1. Group discussion: what are the most effective ways to prevent drug abuse among young people, and why?

Our group agreed on four ways, in order of effectiveness. **(i) Education in school**, because it gives the facts before curiosity begins — a student who knows what ice does to the brain does not need to test it. **(ii) A strong family relationship**, because loneliness is the addict's first door; time and listening at home close that door. **(iii) Sports, arts and clubs**, because a busy and successful young person has something to lose. **(iv) Strict law against dealers**, because drugs must be difficult to get; no amount of counselling can protect a child in a lane where the seller stands openly. We added one more: strict supervision of medicines at home, since many addictions begin with sleeping pills or painkillers taken without a doctor's advice.

2. News broadcast (2–3 minutes) on environmental issues and solutions.

[Anchor:] “Assalam-o-Alaikum and welcome to the school news. Tonight we begin with our city's air. The air quality is unhealthy in three areas, mainly because of vehicle smoke and because garbage is still being burnt in the streets.”

[Reporter in the field:] “I am standing outside the main market, and in the last hour I have counted about forty motorcycles and only one bus. Experts say that one bus can replace about forty motorcycles, which is why the city has announced two new bus routes from next month. Students, meanwhile, have started their own answer: the government school near this market planted two hundred saplings last Sunday, and three schools have opened rooftop gardens.”

[Anchor:] “What does the public need to do? We asked the coordinator of a city clean-up drive.” **[Guest:]** “Two things only: stop burning garbage, and separate your paper and plastic so that they can be recycled. Both cost nothing.”

[Anchor:] “That is all for tonight. Remember: a cleaner Karachi is not the government's job alone. This is your reporter, signing off.”

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3. If you were the King, how would you explain to the hermit why these three questions are so important to you?

“Wise hermit, I am a king, and a king's mistakes do not fall on him alone; they fall on the whole kingdom. If I begin a work at the wrong time, a harvest may fail or a war may be lost. If I listen to the wrong people, I shall reward flatterers and punish honest men. If I do the wrong work first, my days will be full and my country empty. I have asked the learned men of my court and have received as many answers as there were scholars, so I have left my throne and come to you on foot. I do not ask for miracles — only for the knowledge that will keep my power honest. Tell me, I beg you, when I should begin, whom I should trust, and what I should do first.”

D. Writing Skills

1. Write a short essay (2–3 paragraphs) explaining why both education and family involvement are important in preventing drug abuse among young people.

Education and family: two hands that keep the young away from drugs

Drug abuse among the young is not only a police problem; it is a problem of knowledge and of belonging. Education gives the knowledge. A student who has been taught, in words he can understand, what heroin, hashish, opium and ice do to the brain, the heart, the lungs and the liver, is much harder to trap with the sentence “it is only a harmless experiment”. Schools also fight addiction without ever naming it: sports, art, debating and hobby clubs take the restless energy of a teenager and give it a healthy direction, while a counsellor and a teacher who notice a falling mark give help before a habit becomes an addiction.

Family involvement supplies what education cannot — belonging. Most young people who turn to drugs are looking for comfort, escape or acceptance, and these are things a home must give first. Parents who listen without scolding, who take interest in their child's friends, who keep medicines and money safely and who set a clean example make their home the first protection of all. They can also read the early signs — mood swings, new friends, missing money, depression — and respond to them with love instead of shame, so that the child trusts them instead of hiding.

The two together are far stronger than either alone. Education without family turns into an assembly lecture that the child forgets by evening; family without education means good intentions without facts. Together, they produce the only sure defence: a young person who knows the danger and has somewhere safe to go.

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2. Write a paragraph explaining the poet's view of time in the poem “Time”.

In “Time”, Shelley presents time as an unfathomable sea — vast, deep, shoreless and completely beyond human control. Its waves are years, its water is brackish with the salt of human tears, and its ebb and flow hold the whole boundary of mortality. The poet personifies it as a beast that is “sick of prey, yet howling on for more”, that vomits the wrecks of human lives on an inhospitable shore, and that is “treacherous in calm, and terrible in storm”. So his view of time is dark and awe-filled: time is not a gift but a power, not a measurement but a hunger, and no human being can sail on it. The poem closes with a rhetorical question — “Who shall put forth on thee, / Unfathomable Sea?” — and the silence after it is his final statement: man is helpless before time, and the only wisdom left is humility.

3. Write an essay (3–4 paragraphs) discussing the environmental challenges and the actions being taken to address them.

Our planet in danger — and what is being done

The two great environmental challenges of our age are climate change and pollution, and they feed each other. The burning of fossil fuels, deforestation and industry have filled the atmosphere with carbon dioxide, methane and nitrous oxide, which trap heat and raise the average temperature of the Earth. Melting glaciers lift the seas, and hurricanes, floods, heatwaves and wildfires become more frequent and more violent. Pollution does its own work at the same time: smoke from vehicles and factories poisons the air we breathe, plastic and chemicals dumped in rivers poison the water we drink, and deforestation destroys the soil and the biodiversity of a region. The worst damage falls on the poorest countries, which have the smallest share in causing it — which is why the environment is now also a question of justice.

The world's response at the international level is the Paris Agreement of 2015, in which almost every country promised to keep global warming well below 2°C, with efforts to keep it below 1.5°C, by cutting emissions, investing in renewable energy and improving energy efficiency. Governments are enforcing environmental laws, promoting solar and wind power, and improving public transport so that fewer cars carry more citizens. Businesses are shifting to sustainable practices and clean technology, and the falling cost of solar panels and electric vehicles shows that the change is no longer a dream.

Ordinary people and communities have joined in, and this is where the results are most visible. In Islamabad, tree plantation drives have increased green areas; some schools have started rooftop gardens; youth groups organise clean-up drives in parks and along riversides; and streets hold “Green Day” and monthly clean-up campaigns. Families use cloth bags, recycle paper and plastic, save electricity and water, and plant a sapling where they live. The media now reports solutions along with problems, so people feel able to act.

The challenges are still great and emissions are still rising, but the direction of the response is clear. What the world needs now is not a new idea but the will to apply the ideas it already has — and, above all, millions of ordinary people who do small

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things on purpose. A cleaner, greener world will not be built by governments alone; it will be built by students like us, one sapling and one honest habit at a time.

4. Imagine you are the hermit. Write a diary entry describing your encounter with the King, how he behaved and what you thought of his visit.

Diary — the hermit's hut, in the wood

A strange day, and one I shall not forget.

Yesterday afternoon a man came through the trees in simple clothes, alone, with his horse and servants left far behind on the road. His hands were soft and his clothes were rough, and I knew him for a king at once — a nation carries itself in its own way, and rank cannot be hidden by cotton. He asked me three questions about the right time, the right people and the most important work. I said nothing; I was digging, and my breath was shorter than my thoughts. But he did not order me and did not threaten me. After a while he took the spade from my hand and went on with my digging, bed after bed, until the evening was down among the trees.

While he was digging two beds, a man ran out of the wood with blood on his clothes and fell at the foot of the wall. The king knelt down, though his hands were blistered, and washed the wound with his own hand and bound it with his own cloth, sleeping beside the stranger through the night so that the man would not wake alone. In the morning the stranger told us he was the king's enemy and had come to kill him, and that the king's guards had caught him first, and that the man he had planned to murder had saved his life. He asked for pardon on his face, and the king raised him up.

So I told him what his own hands had already taught him: the most important time is the one in which you are acting, the most important person is the one beside you, and the most important work is the good you can do to him now. If he had not stayed with me, he would have been killed on the road home and given them neither mercy nor forgiveness. He listened like a student, not like a king, and thanked me, and asked my blessing.

I have met learned men who could not answer his questions in a week, and a king who answered them in one night by digging and bandaging. I shall keep the spade he used beside the door and say my prayers for him.

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Points to Remember — Review 2 (Units 6–10)

• Unit 6 (Drug Abuse): causes, effects, prevention; education and family are the two strongest defences.

• Unit 7 (Time): unfathomable sea; brackish water; sick of prey yet howling for more; treacherous in calm; who shall put forth on thee?

• Unit 8 (Pollution-free Pakistan): causes of pollution, greenery, awareness, laws, renewable energy, public transport, community campaigns, media.

• Unit 9 (The Road Not Taken): two roads = choices of life; both really about the same; less travelled; the sigh.

• Unit 10 (The Three Questions): now, the person with you, his good — the one answer to all three questions.

• Grammar: past perfect = had + 3rd form; gerund = verb+ing as noun; infinitive = to + base verb; participle = verb form as adjective.

• Indirect speech: change tense, pronouns and time words; questions/orders/requests change form (asked what…, ordered … to, requested/advised … to).

• Punctuation in poetry: capital letters for personified names, commas at line ends, exclamation marks for exclamations.

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